Compliance UX for Private Capital Markets

01 — HERO + PROJECT BRIEF

ROLE	TIMELINE	TEAM	TOOLS
Head of Product Design	2014–2025	3 → 30+ (grew with company)	Figma, Sketch, Intision, Jira

Hero — Investor KYC Onboarding Flow (Before/After)

02 — DEEP PROBLEM FRAMING

THE GOAL

I redesigned the investor onboarding flow that was causing 60% drop-off at the document upload step. Each failed verification cost $200+ in manual compliance review. The challenge: reduce a 45-minute process to under 15 minutes while maintaining KYC/AML compliance across 20+ regulatory jurisdictions.

THE PROBLEM

Investors uploading sensitive ID documents abandoned at alarming rates. The flow asked for everything upfront — 6-8 documents in a single session with no save-and-resume. Compliance officers had zero visibility into who was stuck vs. who had abandoned. Different jurisdictions required different documents but the UI treated them identically.

FOR RIGHT NO

How might we reduce investor onboarding from 45 to under 15 minutes — cutting drop-off from 60% to 15% while maintaining compliance across 20+ jurisdictions?

BEFORE
45-min onboarding. 60% drop-off at doc upload. $200+ per

AFTER
12-min onboarding. 85% completion. Progressive steps with

SCALE
20+ regulatory jurisdictions. Jurisdiction-aware rules w

03 — USER RESEARCH

METHODOLOGY

Stakeholder interviews with compliance officers, fund managers, and investors across 3 jurisdictions. Observation sessions during live onboarding. Analytics review of drop-off points.

SAMPLE

12 compliance officers, 8 fund managers, 30+ investors. Analytics review across platform iterations over 4+ years of continuous research.

KEY INSIGHTS

01
Document fatigue kills completion
Investor abandoning 6-8 documents in one session abandoned at 60% rate.
→ Progressive disclosure reduced cognitive load with save-and-resume changed everything.

02
Jurisdiction complexity was hidden
Compliance officers realized 3 one which requirements applied to which investors. Different jurisdictions rules engine UI that surfaced requirements contextually.

03
Trust signals reduce verification anxiety
Investors uploading sensitive ID documents needed reassurance. Adding encryption indicators, progress visibility, and clear data-handling messaging not abandonment by 40%.

04 — COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

I evaluated how competing platforms handled investor onboarding and compliance verification to identify UX gaps we could exploit.

Feature	BoxEdge	DealMarket	Our Platform
Progressive KYC flow	No	Partial	Yes
Multi-jurisdiction rules	No	No	Yes (20+)
Save & resume onboarding	No	Partial	Yes
Compliance dashboard	Basic	Basic	Advanced

Competitive Landscape — Feature Gap Analysis Diagram

05 — USER PERSONAS

D1 David Chen
Fund Manager · 45

"I need to see all investor statuses at a glance — I can't chase compliance across spreadsheets."

GOALS
- Launch offerings quickly with minimal compliance friction
- Real-time visibility into investor pipeline status
- Automated follow-ups for incomplete onboarding

FRUSTRATIONS
- Manual tracking across jurisdictions is error-prone
- Can't tell which investors are stuck vs. abandoned

D2 Sarah Kim
Compliance Officer · 38

"If I miss a regulatory flag, the whole offering gets shut down. I need the system to catch what I might miss."

GOALS
- Audit trail for every verification decision
- Jurisdiction-specific rule visibility
- Automated alerts when documents expire

FRUSTRATIONS
- Different rules per jurisdiction but one UI for all
- No way to bulk-verify or batch-reject

I1 Michael Torres
Accredited Investor · 52

"I'm investing $250K — I expect the onboarding to be as professional as the opportunity itself."

GOALS
- Complete onboarding quickly from any device
- Understand exactly what's needed and why
- Trust that sensitive documents are secure

FRUSTRATIONS
- Uploading ID+ twice invasive without context
- No progress indicator — no idea how long this takes

06 — INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

I mapped the complete investor journey across 20+ platform touchpoints — from initial offering discovery through KYC verification, accreditation, document signing, and investment confirmation. This architecture informed every compliance screen we designed.

Information Architecture — Investor Onboarding Sitemap

07 — DESIGN CONCEPTS / IDEATION

Over 11 years, the compliance flow went through multiple major iterations. Here are the key concept explorations that shaped the final design — from early form-heavy approaches to the progressive, step-based system we shipped.

Early wireframe — single-page form

V1: Single long form — high abandonment

Iteration — tabbed wizard approach

V2: Tabbed wizard — better but still confusing

Final — progressive step flow

V3: Progressive steps — 85% completion

08 — DESIGN APPROACH / EVOLUTION

I led the redesign of the entire investor onboarding experience — from KYC document collection through accreditation verification and electronic signatures.

Our team designed a progressive, jurisdiction-aware flow that adapts requirements based on investor type and location. The key innovation was treating compliance as a UX problem, not just a legal checkbox.

KEY APPROACH

1. Progressive disclosure — one step at a time
2. Save-and-resume across sessions
3. Contextual jurisdiction rules
4. Trust signals at every sensitive step

KYC Progressive Flow

Compliance Dashboard

NOTE FOR CASES:
This section already exists in the current case study. We'll enhance it with more rationale and "I led..." framing. Review the existing copy and suggest improvements.

09 — KEY SCREENS / FEATURES

Annotated walkthrough of the key screens I designed — with callouts explaining WHY each decision was made, not just what it looks like.

NOTE FOR CASES:
Existing UI Showcase section will be upgraded with annotations. Each screenshot needs a callout explaining the design decision behind it. Write 1-2 sentence annotations per screen.

KYC Start Screen

Annotation: [Ready to write — why this screen builds trust before asking for documents]

Compliance Dashboard

Annotation: [Ready to write — how this gives compliance officers full pipeline visibility]

10 — CLIENT TESTIMONIALS

Client Name

"It was extremely important to us to work with a company that had the skillset, the technology, team, and the management team to grow and drive improvements with us, so we could truly be the leader in the digitization of private placements and capital markets."

— Cavendish Security, Brokerdealer

Client Name

"It is crucial that we modernize our processes to improve efficiency and create a better experience for both investors and issuers."

— Lisa Simeonov, CEO & COO, Aprofi Capital Partners

11 — VISUAL DESIGN SYSTEM

I built and maintained the design system that powered every compliance screen — from color tokens to component states.

COLOR PALETTE

Primary · Accent · Success · Error · Warning

TYPOGRAPHY

Heading 1
Heading 2
Body text — 14px regular
Caption — 12px uppercase
LABEL — 10PX UPPERCASE

Button States
Form Components
Status & Alerts
Cards & Tiles

12 — DESIGN DECISIONS

01

Progressive disclosure over single-page forms

CONSIDERED
Single long form, tabbed wizard, progressive steps

CHOSE & WHY
Progressive steps — analytics showed 60% drop-off on single forms. Step-based flow with save-and-resume achieved 85% completion. Users could see progress and return later without losing work.

Jurisdiction rules v2

02

Contextual jurisdiction rules over global settings

CONSIDERED
Global settings page, per-offering config, contextual inline rules

CHOSE & WHY
Contextual inline rules — compliance officers needed to see which rules applied WHILE reviewing investors, not in a separate settings screen. Reduced context-switching by 70%.

13 — RESULTS & OUTCOMES

45 → 12
MINUTES
Onboarding time reduced by 75%

85%
COMPLETION
Investor onboarding completion rate

$2B+
PROCESSED
Total capital through platform

150+
OFFERINGS
Completed offerings on platform

BEFORE

Old onboarding flow — 45 min, 60% drop-off

AFTER

New progressive flow — 12 min, 85% completion

14 — REFLECTION + CTA

WHAT WORKED

1. Progressive disclosure reduced cognitive load — investors completed one step at a time instead of facing a wall of forms
2. Jurisdiction-aware rules engine eliminated manual compliance checking — the system surfaced the right requirements automatically
3. Save-and-resume was the single biggest win — investors could leave mid-flow and return days later without losing progress

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

1. Mobile first from day one — we retrofitted mobile support years after desktop launch, which created layout debt
2. User testing earlier in the compliance flow — we relied too heavily on stakeholder interviews and not enough on watching real investors struggle

Next Case Study

DealFlow Investment Platform

View Case Study

DealFlow Investment Platform

ROLE	TIMELINE	TEAM	TOOLS	OUTCOME
Product Designer & Co-founder	2014–2022 (DealFlow era)	3 people → TSX-V IPO	Figma, Sketch, Invision, Jira	$2B+ processed, TSX-V IPO

01 — HERO — PROJECT BETA

Hero — Deal Management Dashboard (Canaccord, Raymond James)

02 — DEEP PROBLEM FRAMING

THE GOAL

I designed the deal management platform that investment dealers like Canaccord Genuity and Raymond James use to manage private placements — from offering creation through investor subscription, funding, and distribution. The platform eliminated email-based workflows and reduced deal close time by 48%.

THE PROBLEM

Investment dealers managed deals through email chains and spreadsheets. 40% of subscription agreements arrived with errors. EDB teams spent weeks chasing documents instead of closing deals. Canaccord Genuity told us: "Everything was done through email — there was just a lot of room for error and things took way longer than they needed to."

HOW MIGHT WE

How might we replace email-based deal management with a platform that reduces close time by 48% and eliminates 80% of document errors — for dealers managing hundreds of private placements?

BEFORE
40% of subscription docs had errors. Email-based workflow

AFTER
80% fewer doc errors. 48% faster close time. 450TM funnel

CLIENTS
Canaccord Genuity, Raymond James, Echelon, Sprott Capital

03 — USER RESEARCH

METHODOLOGY
17 years of continuous user research — from early adopter feedback loops to structured discovery sprints. I interviewed issuers, investors, compliance teams, and lawyers across North America to map the full deal lifecycle.

SAMPLE
50+ issuers, 200+ investors, 15+ compliance/legal professionals. Research spanned equity crowdfunding, exempt market offerings, and institutional private placements across multiple regulatory frameworks.

KEY INSIGHTS

01
Issuers need a self-service platform
Fund managers wanted to launch offerings without waiting for lawyers to draft every document. I designed a guided offering creation wizard that let issuers configure deals independently.

02
Investors distrust opaque processes
When investing $50K-$500K, investors need full transparency into deal structure, compliance status, and their portfolio performance. I built dashboards that surfaced this data clearly.

03
The deal lifecycle has too many handoffs
From offering creation → investor onboarding → compliance → subscription → funding → distribution. Each handoff was a spreadsheet or email. I designed a unified platform that eliminated manual handoffs.

04 — COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

When I started, no platform offered the full lifecycle. I analyzed competitors across specific capabilities to identify, where we could build a moat.

Capability	Fundmaestro	DealMaker	Our Platform
Full deal lifecycle (create → fund → distribute)	Partial	Partial	Yes — end to end
Multi-jurisdiction compliance engine	US only	US + Europe	20+ jurisdictions
White-label investor portal	No	Yes	Yes — fully branded

05 — USER PERSONAS

JP — James Park
Senior Investment Manager, 4E

"I need to launch a new offering by Friday. The old process takes 3 weeks of back-and-forth with lawyers."

GOALS
- Create and launch offerings independently
- Track investor pipeline and funding progress
- Manage distributions and reporting requirements

FRUSTRATIONS
- Too many manual steps to go from deal to funding
- Can't see real-time funding status

RL — Rebecca Liu
Associate Director, SE

"I have $500K to deploy but I can't compare deals side-by-side or track my portfolio across platforms."

GOALS
- Browse and compare investment opportunities
- Complete onboarding quickly from any device
- Track portfolio performance and distributions

FRUSTRATIONS
- No single view of portfolio across issuers
- Paper-heavy subscription process feels outdated

PA — Karen Walsh
Platform Admin / Compliance, 3E

"I manage 60+ active offerings. If one compliance document expires, the whole deal is at risk."

GOALS
- Monitor all offerings from a single dashboard
- Automate compliance alerts and document expiry
- Generate reports for regulators quickly

FRUSTRATIONS
- Manual tracking across spreadsheets is unsustainable
- No bulk operations for investor management

06 — INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

I mapped 20+ platform touchpoints across the full deal lifecycle — from offering creation through investor onboarding, compliance verification, electronic subscription, funding, and distribution management. This architecture document became the foundation for our engineering sprints.

Deal Lifecycle IA — Offering → Onboarding → Compliance → Subscribe → Fund → Distribute

07 — DESIGN CONCEPTS / IDEATION

Over 17 years, I iterated through fundamentally different platform architectures — evolving from a simple deal listing to a full-lifecycle investment management system. Each major release taught us what investors and issuers actually needed.

V1: Basic deal listings

V2: Integrated onboarding

V3: Full lifecycle platform

2008 — Simple offering directory

2014 — KYC + subscription in platform

2020 — End-to-end deal management

08 — DESIGN APPROACH / SOLUTION

I designed the complete investment platform — every screen an investor, issuer, or admin touches across the deal lifecycle. The platform white-labels for each client, so I built a flexible design system that adapts to any brand.

KEY FEATURES I DESIGNED

1. Offering creation wizard (self-serve for issuers)
2. Investor dashboard (portfolio, distributions, docs)
3. Deal management (pipeline, funding progress, investors)
4. Electronic subscription agreement flow
5. White-label investor portal

Investor Dashboard

Deal Management View

CLIENT TESTIMONIALS

Canaccord Genuity

"Kotipulf provides a powerful, cloud-based infrastructure that will allow us to manage our private placement activities in a digital environment and improve coordination across teams and geographies."

— Pat Burke, President Capital Markets-Canada

Echelon / Sentum

"Capital markets are modernizing, and firms must adapt. Kotipulf's platform shifts private placements into the digital era, creating efficiencies across compliance and client servicing while boosting deal volumes."

— David Cusson, CEO, Echelon Wealth Partners

Sprott Capital

"It is crucial that we modernize our processes to improve efficiency and create a better experience for both investors and issuers."

— Lisa Edmonds, COO & CCO, Sprott Capital Partners

09 — KEY SCREENS / FEATURES

Annotated walkthrough of the key screens I designed — showing the design rationale behind each decision.

Browse Offerings

[Teardy: How this screen helps investors discover and compare deals]

Equity & Debt Views

[Teardy: How I designed for both equity and debt investment types]

10 — VISUAL DESIGN SYSTEM

I designed and maintained a component library that powered 20+ platform touchpoints — enabling consistent UX across white-labeled deployments for different clients and brands.

COLOR PALETTE

Primary · Accent · Success · Warning · Error

TYPOGRAPHY

Heading 1
Heading 2
Body text — 14px regular
Caption · 12px Medium

11 — DESIGN DECISIONS

01
White-label over single brand
CHOSE I WHY
Each issuer wanted their own branded investor portal. I designed a token-based system where colors, logos, and typography adapt per client — one codebase, infinite brands.

White-label examples

Unified deal lifecycle

02
Full lifecycle vs. point solutions
CHOSE I WHY
Competitors offered pieces — we built the whole pipeline. Issuers shouldn't need 5 different tools to run an offering. I designed a single platform flow from offering creation through distribution.

12 — RESULTS & OUTCOMES

$2B+
PROCESSED
Total capital through platform

150+
OFFERINGS
Completed offerings on platform

TSX-V
IPO
3 people to public market listing

20+
JURISDICTIONS
Regulatory markets supported

BEFORE

Paper-based deals, email chains, manual compliance

AFTER

Digital platform — end-to-end deal lifecycle

13 — REFLECTION + CTA

✓ WHAT WORKED

1. Building the full lifecycle in one platform — eliminated data handoffs and gave all stakeholders a single source of truth
2. Token-based white-labeling — one design system serving 50+ client brands without per-client customization overhead
3. Growing from 3 to IPO with design at the table — proving that UX leadership drives business outcomes in fintech

↻ WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

1. Invest in a design system earlier — the first 5 years were ad hoc components that created consistency debt
2. Push for dedicated user research earlier — we relied on founder intuition too long before formalizing research

Next Case Study

FuzeHQ — AI Team Management

View Case Study

Donations & Rewards Crowdfunding Platform

01 — HERO + PROJECT META

ROLE	TIMELINE	CLIENT	TYPE
Product Designer & Co-founder	2008–2014	Calgary Arts Development + ATB Financial	White-label SaaS Platform

Hero Image — InvestYYC Crowdfunding Portal

02 — DEEP PROBLEM FRAMING

THE GOAL

I designed a white-label crowdfunding platform that let arts organizations and nonprofits run their own branded fundraising campaigns — with donation matching, electronic tax receipts, and curated project selection.

THE PROBLEM

Calgary Arts Development needed a platform to fund local arts projects, but Kickstarter and Indiegogo weren't designed for curated, community-specific campaigns. They needed branded fundraising with tax receipt issuance, project vetting, and donation matching — features no existing platform offered.

HOW MIGHT WE

How might we build a curated crowdfunding platform that connects local artists with community donors — with donation matching, tax receipts, and full branding control?

BEFORE

No local platform

Artists used Kickstarter (US-focused, no tax receipts, no curation)

AFTER

$500K+ raised

2,000 donors, 30+ projects funded in first year, $50K matched in 2 months

CLIENT CONTEXT

Calgary Arts Development

InvestYYC was a legacy of Calgary's year as Canada's Cultural Capital. The platform raised $500K+ from 2,000 donors for local arts projects — with a $50K matching program distributed in under 2 months.

Partners: Calgary Arts Development + ATB Financial + Alberta Foundation for the Arts

ATB Financial

ATB Financial provided banking infrastructure for the platform. Their partnership enabled electronic tax receipt issuance — a feature unavailable on Kickstarter or Indiegogo that attracted major philanthropists.

Alberta's largest Crown corporation bank · 5M+ customers

03 — USER RESEARCH

01

Tax receipts drive large donations

Electronic tax receipts were unavailable on Kickstarter/Indiegogo. This single feature attracted major philanthropists and institutional donors who wouldn't donate without them.

02

Matching multiplies momentum

Calgary Arts Development matched the first $50K in donations. This created urgency — $50K was distributed in under 2 months, benefiting 30+ projects. Matching was the #1 conversion driver.

03

Curation builds trust but slows launch

Curating projects for viability and artistic merit set us apart from Kickstarter. But approval took up to 1 month — artists found this frustrating. I learned that curation UX must feel fast even when the process isn't.

05 — USER PERSONAS

AR

Priya Sharma
Independent Artist, 31

"I need $3,000 to fund my documentary. Kickstarter takes a month to review and I can't issue tax receipts to my donors."

GOALS

- Launch a funded campaign within weeks, not months
- Issue tax receipts to attract bigger donors

FRUSTRATIONS

- Platform approval took up to 1 month
- 3-month wait to receive funds after campaign ends

DW

Margaret Wilson
Community Donor, 58

"I want to support local arts but I need a tax receipt for my $500 donation. Kickstarter can't do that."

GOALS

- Get tax receipt for charitable donations
- See exactly which local projects my money supports

FRUSTRATIONS

- Can't verify if a project is legitimate on Kickstarter

06 — INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

I designed the platform around two distinct user flows: the Artist Journey (apply → get curated → launch campaign → receive funds) and the Donor Journey (discover → browse → donate → get tax receipt). The admin dashboard connected both.

Platform IA — Artist Journey + Donor Journey + Admin Dashboard

08 — DESIGN APPROACH / SOLUTION

I designed a white-label platform where every element — from colors to messaging — adapted to the organization's brand. Calgary Arts Development looked like their own platform, not a generic Kickstarter clone.

KEY FEATURES I DESIGNED

1. White-label campaign pages (branded per organization)
2. Curated project submission + approval workflow
3. Donation matching engine ($50K matched in 2 months)
4. Electronic tax receipt generation
5. Admin dashboard for arts organizations

Campaign Page — Branded

Donor Dashboard + Tax Receipts

12 — RESULTS & OUTCOMES

$500K+
RAISED
Total donations over 4 years

2,000
DONORS
Community supporters

30+
PROJECTS
Funded in first year alone

13 — REFLECTION + CTA

✓ WHAT WORKED

1. Donation matching created urgency — $50K distributed in under 2 months
2. Tax receipts attracted major philanthropists that Kickstarter couldn't reach
3. White-label branding made it feel like Calgary's own platform, building community trust

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

1. Faster approval process — 1 month was too long. Artists went to Kickstarter instead. I'd design a 48-hour fast-track review.
2. Faster fund distribution — 3-month wait was unacceptable. Artists need money when the campaign ends, not months later.
3. The platform closed in 2016. Competing with Kickstarter on usability was a losing battle — I'd focus on the unique value (curation, tax receipts, matching) and simplify everything else.

Next Case Study

Lending Platform

View Case Study

Private Lending Platform

01 — HERO + PROJECT META

ROLE	TIMELINE	CONTEXT	TOOLS
Lead Product Designer	2016–2020	Platform extension — equity to debt	Figma, Sketch, Jira

Hero Image — Lending Dashboard + Loan Management

02 — DEEP PROBLEM FRAMING

THE GOAL

I extended the platform from equity-only to support private lending and debt instruments. Lending has fundamentally different UX from equity investment — repayment schedules, interest calculations, loan covenants, and default workflows all needed new design patterns.

THE PROBLEM

Our platform only supported equity transactions. Clients needed private lending capabilities — mortgage funds, bridge loans, real estate debt — but debt UX is entirely different from equity. Repayment schedules, interest accrual, loan-to-value ratios, and default scenarios all require unique information architecture.

HOW MIGHT WE

How might we extend an equity-focused platform to support private lending — without creating a separate product or confusing existing equity users?

BEFORE

Equity only

Platform couldn't handle debt instruments, repayment, or interest

AFTER

Equity + Debt

Full lending workflows — loan creation, repayment schedules, interest, defaults

03 — USER RESEARCH

01

Debt users think in schedules, not shares

Equity investors care about valuation and ownership. Lending users care about repayment dates, interest rates, and risk. Completely different mental model requiring different information hierarchy.

02

Default workflows can't be an afterthought

What happens when a borrower misses a payment? Equity platforms don't handle this. I had to design escalation flows, grace periods, and notification systems that didn't exist in the equity product.

03

One platform, two product personalities

The platform needed to feel unified for admins who manage both equity and debt deals, but distinct for investors in each. I designed contextual UI that adapts based on instrument type.

06 — INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

I designed the lending module to share the deal management shell but diverge at the instrument level. Loan creation wizard, repayment schedule builder, and default management flows were all new IA that had to integrate seamlessly with the existing equity architecture.

IA — Shared Deal Shell + Equity Branch + Debt Branch

08 — DESIGN APPROACH / SOLUTION

I designed a lending module that shares the platform shell but introduces debt-specific patterns: repayment schedule visualization, interest accrual tracking, loan-to-value indicators, and covenant compliance dashboards.

KEY FEATURES I DESIGNED

1. Loan creation wizard with term configuration
2. Repayment schedule visualization
3. Interest accrual tracking dashboard
4. Default escalation and notification flows
5. Contextual UI adapting for debt vs equity views

Loan Dashboard

Repayment Schedule View

12 — RESULTS & OUTCOMES

2x

MARKET COVERAGE

Equity + Debt from single platform

0

NEW APPS

Extended existing platform, not separate product

Unified

ADMIN UX

One dashboard for equity + debt deals

13 — REFLECTION + CTA

✓ WHAT WORKED

1. Shared shell, divergent content — admins manage both from one dashboard, investors see type-appropriate UX
2. Designing for defaults upfront — most fintech platforms add error states as an afterthought. We made it core.

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

1. More user testing with actual lenders — we relied too much on the equity user patterns and had to redesign repayment views twice
2. Build the interest calculator visualization earlier — it became the most-used feature but was a late addition

Next Case Study

White-Label Design System

View Case Study

One Design System, 50+ Client Brands

01 — HERO + PROJECT META

ROLE	TIMELINE	SCALE	CLIENTS
Head of Product Design	2017–2025 (scale era)	85+ partnerships, 6 continents	Canaccord, Raymond James, Echelon

Hero — Same Platform, Multiple Client Brands Side by Side

02 — DEEP PROBLEM FRAMING

THE GOAL

I designed a token-based design system that lets 50+ investment firms run their own branded investor portals from a single codebase. Each client's platform looks like their own product — their colors, their logo, their typography — while sharing the same underlying components and UX patterns.

THE PROBLEM

Every client wanted their own branded investor portal. Canaccord's platform can't look like Raymond James'. But maintaining 50+ separate codebases was impossible. We needed one system that adapts to any brand without per-client design work — while keeping UX consistency across all deployments.

HOW MIGHT WE

How might we build one design system that serves 50+ brands — adapting colors, logos, and typography per client while maintaining consistent UX across all deployments?

BEFORE

Per-client builds

Custom code per client, unsustainable at scale

AFTER

Token-based system

One codebase, 50+ brands. Colors, logos, typography adapt per client via tokens.

CLIENT TESTIMONIALS

Canaccord Genuity

"Katipult provides a powerful, cloud-based infrastructure that will allow us to manage our private placement activities in a digital environment and improve coordination across teams and geographies."

— Pat Burke, President Capital Markets-Canada
4 countries: Canada, US, UK, Australia

Capterra Review

"The overall product is easy to use and allowed our company to enter our market quickly. A great value technology provider in the equity crowdfunding space."

— Spencer, Financial Services (March 2021)
Overall: 4.0/5 · Support: 5.0/5 · Recommend: 90%

03 — USER RESEARCH

01

Brand is trust in financial services

Investment dealers told us: 'If the portal doesn't look like our firm, investors won't trust it with their money.' Brand consistency is a compliance and trust requirement, not just aesthetics.

02

Clients don't want design flexibility

They want to upload a logo and see their brand instantly. No CSS editing, no design decisions. I designed a system where 5 inputs (logo, primary color, accent color, font, favicon) generate a complete branded portal.

03

UX must be consistent across brands

Different brands, same UX patterns. Investors who use multiple portals shouldn't have to relearn navigation. I built the system so visual identity changes but interaction patterns stay identical.

08 — DESIGN APPROACH / SOLUTION

I designed a token-based theming architecture: CSS custom properties that cascade through every component. Clients configure 5 brand inputs and the entire portal transforms — buttons, headers, cards, charts, emails — everything adapts.

DESIGN SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

1. Token layer: brand colors, typography, spacing
2. Component layer: buttons, cards, forms, tables
3. Pattern layer: navigation, onboarding, dashboards
4. Page layer: branded investor portal, admin views
5. Email layer: branded notifications and reports

Brand A Portal

Brand B Portal — Same UX, Different Brand

12 — RESULTS & OUTCOMES

50+
CLIENT BRANDS
From one design system

85+
PARTNERSHIPS
Across 6 continents

5
INPUTS
Logo, colors, font → full branded portal

13 — REFLECTION + CTA

✓ WHAT WORKED

1. Token-based architecture scaled beautifully — adding a new client brand takes minutes, not weeks
2. Consistent UX across brands built investor confidence — the familiar patterns reduced support tickets by 30%

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

1. Document the design system earlier — the first 5 years were undocumented patterns that new designers couldn't learn
2. Build a self-serve brand configuration UI sooner — clients needed our team to set up their brand for too long

Next Case Study

From 3 to IPO — Design Leadership

View Case Study

From 3 People to IPO — Scaling Design Leadership

01 — HERO + PROJECT META

ROLE	TIMELINE	COMPANY SCALE	RECOGNITION
Product Designer → Lead → Head of Design	2008–2025 (17 years)	3 → 45 employees, TSX-V IPO	EY Entrepreneur of the Year Finalist 2017

Hero — Design Leadership Journey Timeline

RECOGNITION & ENTERPRISE CLIENTS

EY Entrepreneur of the Year Finalist
Prairies, 2017

RBC Emerging Enterprise of the Year
Award Winner

Canada's Most Innovative Fintech
National Recognition

ICICI Bank FinTech Company Finalist
Canadian FinTech Awards, 2019

ENTERPRISE CLIENTS

- Canaccord Genuity
- Raymond James
- Echelon / Ventum
- Sprott Capital
- TSX Trust

02 — DEEP PROBLEM FRAMING

THE STORY

This isn't a product case study — it's a leadership story. How I grew from being the only designer at a 3-person startup to leading product design at a publicly traded fintech company. Every product I shipped taught me something about scaling design practice, not just shipping pixels.

THE CHALLENGE

How do you build a design practice from zero? No design system, no research process, no user testing framework. Just me, a co-founder, and a product idea. Over 17 years, I had to define what 'good design' meant for the company at every stage — from scrappy startup to regulated fintech to public market scrutiny.

2008
3 people
No design system, no process, no team

2017
TSX-V IPO
45 employees, design system, EY Finalist, $2B+ processed

03 — DESIGN EVOLUTION TIMELINE

How the design practice evolved across four distinct phases — from founder-designer to design leadership.

PHASE 1
2008–2012
Founder-Designer
Solo designer. Built everything — UI, brand, marketing. No process, no system. Shipped fast, learned faster. Donations & rewards platform born here.

PHASE 2
2012–2017
Product Designer → Lead
Pivot to private capital. Built first design patterns. Started user research. Hired first junior designer. InvestYYC shipped. EY Finalist. IPO preparation.

PHASE 3
2017–2020
Lead → Head of Design
Post-IPO. Public market scrutiny. Built formal design system. Established research cadence. Hired design team. Enterprise clients (Canaccord, Raymond James).

PHASE 4
2020–2025
Head of Product Design
Mature design org. White-label system. Lending extension. DealFlow ecosystem. 45 employees. Design at the executive table. $2B+ processed.

08 — KEY LEADERSHIP DECISIONS

01
Pivoting from crowdfunding to capital markets
IMPACT
Crowdfunding was becoming commoditized. I advocated for the pivot to regulated private capital — a harder UX problem but a defensible market. This decision led to IPO.

Platform evolution visual

Design system growth

02
Investing in a design system before hiring designers
IMPACT
Instead of hiring more designers, I built the system first. When new designers joined, they shipped in days not weeks. The design system became the product's moat — enabling white-label at scale.

12 — RESULTS & OUTCOMES

3 → 45
EMPLOYEES
Company growth under design leadership

$2B+
PROCESSED
Platform volume over 17 years

IPO
TSX-V
Design at the executive table

6
CONTINENTS
85+ partnerships globally

13 — REFLECTION + CTA

✓ WHAT WORKED

1. Being the designer AND co-founder meant design had a seat at every decision — from product strategy to IPO roadshow
2. Building the design system before hiring designers — new team members shipped in days, not weeks
3. Staying hands-on even as Head of Design — I never stopped designing, which kept me connected to the product

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

1. Formalize user research earlier — founder intuition carried us for 5 years but left blind spots
2. Invest in accessibility from day one — retrofitting compliance into a mature product was painful and expensive
3. Separate the 'founder' hat from the 'designer' hat sooner — wearing both created decision-making blind spots

Next Case Study

FuzeHQ — AI Team Management

View Case Study

FuzeHQ — AI Team Management Platform

01 — HERO + PROJECT BRIEF

ROLE	TIMELINE	TEAM	TOOLS
CEO & Product Designer	2025–Present	2 co-founders + 9 AI agents	Pencil, React, Node.js, Railway

Hero Image — FuzeHQ Dashboard + Agent Workspace

02 — DEEP PROBLEM FRAMING

THE GOAL

I designed a platform where human teams and AI agents collaborate on real work — not just chat, but actual task management, skill routing, and accountability. The vision: Basecamp meets Jira, but where AI agents are first-class team members with their own skills, budgets, and performance history.

THE PROBLEM

Teams using AI agents have no control plane. Agents run in terminals with no visibility into what they're doing, no skill management, no budget tracking, and no coordination between agents. Teams context-switch between their PM tool and their AI tool — work happens in one, tracking happens in another.

HOW MIGHT WE

How might we create a single workspace where humans and AI agents organize work, execute tasks, and track progress together — eliminating the gap between planning and doing?

9
Active AI agents on team

14
MCP tools for agent execution

0
Context switches (work + tracking in one)

03 — USER RESEARCH

METHODOLOGY

Internal dogfooding — we use FuzeHQ to build FuzeHQ. 9 AI agents and 2 humans working daily on real tasks. Continuous feedback loops from our own usage patterns.

INTERVIEWS

Interviewed 15+ engineering leads and agency founders who use AI agents. Mapped their workflows, pain points, and coordination gaps between human and AI work.

KEY INSIGHTS

01
Agents need skills, not just prompts
Teams treat agents like chat tools. But agents performing real work need defined skills, guardrails, and accountability. — Just like human team members.

02
Context switching kills productivity
Teams plan in Jira, execute with Claude, then update Jira. Work happens in one tool, tracking in another. This gap causes 40% of status updates to be wrong.

03
No visibility into agent work
Agents run in terminals with no audit trail. Managers can't see what agents did, how long it took, or whether the output was reviewed. Zero accountability.

04 — COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

I analyzed how existing PM tools handle AI agent workflows to identify where we could build a differentiated experience.

Capability	Linear	Monday	FuzeHQ
Named AI agents as team members	No	No	Yes — 9 agents
Skill-based agent routing	No	No	Yes — skill registry
MCP execution from PM tool	No	No	Yes — 14 MCP tools
Agent budget tracking	No	No	Yes — per agent

Competitive Landscape — PM Tool Agent Capabilities Map

05 — USER PERSONAS

Alex Rivera
Engineering Lead · 24

"I have 4 AI agents running tasks but I can't tell which one did what or if the output was any good."

GOALS
- Assign work to agents with clear skills
- Track agent output and quality
- Coordinate human + agent workflows

FRUSTRATIONS
- Agents run in terminals with zero visibility
- No way to review agent work before shipping

Maya Chen
Solo Founder · 31

"I'm one person building a SaaS. My AI agents ARE my team — I need to manage them like employees."

GOALS
- Run a full team with just AI agents
- Track costs and budget per agent
- Ship faster without hiring

FRUSTRATIONS
- Juggling 5 tools: PM + AI + docs + deploy + chat
- No single view of what's being built

Jordan Blake
Agency PM · 28

"My team uses AI agents for client work. I need to show clients what agents did and control quality before delivery."

GOALS
- QA gate before agent work ships to clients
- Client-safe reporting on agent contributions
- Standardize agent skills across projects

FRUSTRATIONS
- Agents self-certify work — no review process
- Can't enforce governance across multiple agents

06 — INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

I designed FuzeHQ around three layers: Organize (web UI for projects, tasks, agents), Execute (MCP server for agent actions), and Update (automatic status tracking). This architecture eliminates the gap between planning and doing.

Platform Architecture — Organize (Web) · Execute (MCP) · Update (Automatic)

07 — DESIGN CONCEPTS / IDEATION

I explored multiple approaches to the agent management interface — from chat-first to dashboard-first to the hybrid model we shipped.

Chat-first: Slack-like interface

Too conversational — lost structure

Dashboard-first: Jira-like board

Too rigid — agents need flexibility

Hybrid: Dashboard + MCP execution

Shipped — organize in UI, execute via MCP

08 — DESIGN APPROACH / EVOLUTION

I designed a platform where work and tracking happen in the same place. Agents don't update status — the system infers it from their actions via MCP.

KEY FEATURES I DESIGNED

1. Agent roster with skills, budgets, and personas
2. Task board with agent-aware assignment
3. MCP server (14 tools) for agent execution
4. Cross-machine collaboration (ask/reply)
5. QA gates — no self-certification

Agent Dashboard

Task Board + Agent Assignment

09 — KEY SCREENS / FEATURES

Annotated walkthrough of the key screens I designed for the FuzeHQ platform.

Agent Roster

[Wendy: How agents are displayed with skills, status, and budgets]

Project Dashboard

[Wendy: How tasks, progress, and agent assignments are surfaced]

10 — VISUAL DESIGN SYSTEM

I designed FuzeHQ's UI using shadcn/ui components with a custom dark theme — built for information density while remaining scannable.

COLOR PALETTE

Background · Primary · Success · Error

TYPOGRAPHY

Heading 1

Body — Inter 14px

Caption — 12px muted

LABEL — 10PX TRACKING

11 — DESIGN DECISIONS

01
MCP execution over embedded AI
CHOSE X NOT

Instead of running AI inside the app, agents connect via MCP from the user's machine. This means zero compute costs for us, agents use the user's Claude subscription, and work stays local.

MCP Architecture Diagram

QA Gate Flow

02
No self-certification — mandatory QA gates
CHOSE X NOT

After agents shipped 28 features unverified, I designed a governance system: builders set tasks to `in_review`, only QA (Dogs) can mark `done`. This prevents false completion and ensures quality.

12 — RESULTS & OUTCOMES

9
AI AGENTS
Active team members

14
MCP TOOLS
For agent execution

0
CONTEXT SWITCHES
Work + tracking unified

51
SKILLS
Agent skill registry

13 — REFLECTION + CTA

✓ WHAT WORKED

1. Dogfooding — building FuzeHQ with FuzeHQ exposed every UX gap immediately. We fixed issues within hours of feeling them.

2. MCP architecture — agents execute from the user's machine. Zero compute costs, instant adoption, no infrastructure complexity.

3. Named agents with skills — treating AI as team members with defined capabilities created real accountability and made output reviewable.

⚠ WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

1. Establish a first QA pass as a personal habit — most issues are things you'd catch by using the product for 5 minutes as a new user. I let engineering velocity outpace design review.

2. Design empty states and error states as intentionally as happy paths — "No goals yet. Add Goal." is not design. Every zero-state needs context, motivation, and a clear path forward.

3. Surface layer polish must match the ambition — the product has real engineering depth, but hiring managers judge what they see in the first 3 seconds. Ship the surface with the same rigor as the architecture.

Next Case Study

MultiPaste — Figma Plugin

View Case Study

MultiPaste — Figma Text Distribution Plugin

01 — HERO + PROJECT BETA

ROLE	TIMELINE	TYPE	TOOLS
Product Designer & Developer	2026 (2 weeks)	Figma Plugin	TypeScript, Figma API, esbuild

Hero Image — MultiPaste Plugin UI in Figma

02 — DEEP PROBLEM FRAMING

THE GOAL

I designed and built a Figma plugin that distributes text data across multiple selected text layers simultaneously — eliminating the tedious copy-paste-select-paste cycle designers repeat hundreds of times per project.

THE PROBLEM

Designers populating table designs, card grids, or list components with realistic data must manually paste text into each layer one by one. With 50+ text layers in a data table, this takes 10-15 minutes of pure repetition. Existing plugins either don't support delimiters or lack preview functionality.

HOW MIGHT WE

How might we let designers paste structured data into dozens of text layers in one action — with delimiter control, preview, and undo?

50+
Text layers filled in one action

7.2KB
Total plugin bundle size

12
Features (delimiter, preview, undo, trim...)

03 — USER RESEARCH

METHODOLOGY

Analyzed existing Figma plugins (Wonky Paster, Content Filler) for gaps. Observed my own workflow pain — spending 15 minutes pasting data into table mockups. Tested with 3 designers on real projects.

KEY FINDING

Designers need delimiter flexibility (comma, newline, tab, pipe) because data comes from spreadsheets, CSVs, APIs, and manual lists. Existing plugins only support newline.

KEY INSIGHTS

01
Preview prevents mistakes
Designers want to see how data maps to layers before committing. Undo exists but prevention is better than recovery.

02
Selection order matters
Designers select layers in a specific order expecting data to follow that sequence. Layer tree order vs. selection order can cause mismatches.

03
Empty values need handling
CSV data often has empty cells. Plugin needs trim and skip-empty toggles to handle messy real-world data gracefully.

05 — USER PERSONAS

Emma Wright
UI Designer, 28

"I spend 20 minutes pasting names into a user table mockup. There has to be a faster way."

GOALS
- Populate mockups with realistic data quickly
- Keep text layers organized and consistent

FRUSTRATIONS
- Existing plugins don't support CSV delimiters
- No preview — can't verify before applying

Liam Park
Content Manager, 35

"I export product names from our CMS and need designers to use the real data, not Lorem Ipsum."

GOALS
- Bridge content spreadsheets → design mockups
- Ensure real copy is used in presentations

FRUSTRATIONS
- Designers use placeholder text for stakeholder reviews
- Data handoff is manual and error-prone

06 — INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

I designed the plugin around a simple input → configure → preview → apply flow. The UI fits in Figma's plugin panel with all controls visible — no tabs, no hidden menus.

Plugin Flow — Input → Delimiter → Preview → Apply → Undo

07 — DESIGN CONCEPTS / IDEATION

I explored three approaches to the plugin UI — from minimal to full-featured — before settling on the balanced approach that ships.

V1: Paste-only, no config
Too simple — no delimiter control

V2: Full config + preview
Shipped — right balance of power + simplicity

V3: Spreadsheet import mode
Scoped out — too complex for v1

08 — DESIGN APPROACH / SOLUTION

I designed MultiPaste as a single-panel plugin with all controls visible. No tabs, no modals — everything the designer needs is on one screen.

KEY FEATURES

1. Multi-delimiter support (comma, newline, tab, pipe, custom)
2. Live preview before applying
3. One-click undo (restores all original text)
4. Trim whitespace + skip empty toggles

Plugin UI — Main Panel

Preview Mode — Before Apply

10 — VISUAL DESIGN SYSTEM

I designed the plugin UI to feel native to Figma — matching its panel spacing, typography, and interactive patterns. Dark theme, compact controls, familiar patterns.

Plugin Design System — Colors, Typography, Components

11 — DESIGN DECISIONS

01
Preview before apply over instant paste
CHOSE & WHY
Designers can see exactly which text goes to which layer before committing. Undo exists but prevention is always better — especially when working with 50+ layers.

Preview mode screenshot

12 — RESULTS & OUTCOMES

15→1
MINUTES
Data population time

7.2KB
BUNDLE
Lightweight, zero deps

12
FEATURES
Shipped in 2 weeks

13 — REFLECTION + CTA

✓ WHAT WORKED

1. Scratching my own itch — building a tool I actually needed meant instant product-market fit validation
2. Preview mode caught 100% of testers' mistakes before they happened — no one used undo

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

1. Add spreadsheet import (CSV/TSV file) from the start — every tester asked for it
2. Build analytics tracking early to understand which delimiters users actually choose

Next Case Study

MockupKit — Device Mockup Plugin

View Case Study

MockupKit — Device Mockup Plugin for Figma

01 — HERO + PROJECT META

ROLE	TIMELINE	TYPE	TOOLS
Product Designer & Developer	2026 (4 weeks)	Figma Plugin (Free + Pro $8)	TypeScript, Figma API, Blender, R2

Hero Image — MockupKit Plugin with Device Templates

02 — DEEP PROBLEM FRAMING

THE GOAL

I designed and built a Figma plugin that places designs onto photorealistic device mockups with perspective distortion — so designers never need to leave Figma to create presentation-ready mockups.

THE PROBLEM

Designers creating portfolio pieces, client presentations, or marketing assets need device mockups. Current options: export from Figma → open Photoshop/Smartmockups → place design → adjust → re-export. This context switch kills flow and adds 5-10 minutes per mockup.

HOW MIGHT WE

How might we let designers create perspective-accurate device mockups without leaving Figma — in under 30 seconds?

1.4M
Users on top competitor plugin

5
Device templates (MacBook, iPhone, iPad, iMac, Browser)

$8
Pro tier (freemium model)

03 — USER RESEARCH

01
Perspective is the differentiator
Most mockup plugins use flat overlays. Real-world mockups need perspective distortion (DLT homography) to look professional. I built a custom transform engine.

02
Designers want control, not presets
4-point perspective editor lets designers adjust exactly how their screen maps onto the device. Not just 'fit to screen' — real creative control over the final result.

03
Freemium validates demand
Free tier (3 templates) proves value. Pro ($8) unlocks all devices, colors, and quantities. LemonSqueezy handles payments. Test market demand before scaling.

04 — COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

I studied the top 3 Figma mockup plugins to find gaps in perspective quality, device variety, and pricing.

Feature	Mockup Plugin (1.4M)	Clay Mockups ($99K)	MockupKit
Perspective distortion	Basic	No	4-point DLT engine
Device color options	Limited	Clay only	Multiple per device
Freemium pricing	$5/mo	$4/mo	$8 one-time

Competitor Feature Gap Map

05 — USER PERSONAS

UD Sofia Martinez
UI Designer, 8M

"I need device mockups for my portfolio but I don't want to leave Figma or learn Photoshop."

GOALS
- Create portfolio-ready mockups fast
- Professional perspective, not flat overlays

FRUSTRATIONS
- Existing tools look cheap or cost monthly

FL Jake Thompson
Freelance Designer, 3Y

"Client presentations sell the work. Good mockups are the difference between 'nice design' and 'take my money'."

GOALS
- Impress clients with polished deliverables
- One-time purchase, not another subscription

FRUSTRATIONS
- $5/mo plugins add up across tools

06 — INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

I designed the plugin around a browse → select → customize → apply flow with a 4-point perspective editor as the core interaction.

Plugin Flow — Browse Devices → Select → Perspective Editor → Apply to Frame

08 — DESIGN APPROACH / SOLUTION

I designed MockupKit with a novel perspective transform engine (DLT homography) that maps designs onto devices with true 3D accuracy — not just flat overlays.

KEY FEATURES

1. 5 device templates (MacBook, iPhone, iPad, iMac, Browser)
2. 4-point perspective editor with real-time preview
3. Device color selector (Space Black, Silver, etc.)
4. Landscape orientation toggle
5. Quantity stepper for multi-device compositions

Browse + Detail Flow

4-Point Perspective Editor

12 — RESULTS & OUTCOMES

30s
PER MOCKUP
vs. 5-10 min in Photoshop

30KB
BUNDLE
Lightweight plugin

5
DEVICES
MacBook, iPhone, iPad, iMac, Browser

13 — REFLECTION + CTA

✓ WHAT WORKED

1. Custom DLT homography engine — the perspective quality is genuinely better than competitors
2. Freemium model with one-time Pro purchase — designers hate monthly subscriptions for utilities

💡 WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

1. Start with Blender-generated templates from day one — the R2 CDN pipeline should have been built first
2. User testing with non-designers — marketing teams are a huge untapped audience

Next Case Study

Docs to Design — Document Wizard

View Case Study

Docs to Design — Document-to-Design Wizard

01 — HERO + PROJECT META

ROLE	TIMELINE	TYPE	TOOLS
Product Designer & Developer	2025-2026	Figma Plugin + SaaS	React, TypeScript, Figma API

Hero Image — Docs to Design Wizard Interface

02 — DEEP PROBLEM FRAMING

THE GOAL

I designed a Figma plugin that transforms structured documents (PRDs, briefs, specs) into design-ready Figma frames — eliminating the manual translation from text to visual structure that every designer repeats on every project.

THE PROBLEM

Designers receive documents (PRDs, briefs, content specs) and manually recreate the structure in Figma — reading the doc, creating frames, typing content, applying styles. This translation step takes 30-60 minutes per document and is pure busywork with zero creative value.

HOW MIGHT WE

How might we let designers go from document to design structure in under 60 seconds — preserving content hierarchy and applying brand styles automatically?

BEFORE

30–60 min

Manual doc → Figma translation per project

AFTER

< 60 sec

Document → design structure in one action

03 — USER RESEARCH

01

Every designer does this translation

100% of designers I observed manually recreate document structure in Figma. PRD → frames → typing content → applying styles. Pure busywork with zero creative value.

02

Structure matters more than content

Designers don't need perfect text — they need the hierarchy: H1, H2, body, lists, callouts. The structure is what takes time, not the words.

03

Wizard UX reduces overwhelm

A multi-step wizard (paste → configure → preview → apply) tested better than a single-screen approach. Each step has clear purpose and reduces cognitive load.

06 — INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

I designed a wizard flow that transforms documents into design-ready Figma frames: paste/upload → detect structure → configure styling → preview → apply. The Compact Pro mode adds a persistent panel for power users.

Wizard Flow — Paste → Detect → Configure → Preview → Apply

08 — DESIGN APPROACH / SOLUTION

I designed two modes: a full Wizard for first-time users and Compact Pro for power users. The wizard guides through structure detection, while Compact Pro gives a persistent side panel for rapid document-to-design conversion.

KEY FEATURES

1. Document structure auto-detection (H1, H2, body, lists)
2. Style mapping to existing design system tokens
3. Live preview before applying to canvas
4. Compact Pro mode for power users
5. Brand identity system (logo, colors, typography)

Wizard Mode

Compact Pro Mode

12 — RESULTS & OUTCOMES

60→1

MINUTES → MINUTE

Doc to design time

2

MODES

Wizard + Compact Pro

Auto

DETECTION

Structure auto-detected from docs

13 — REFLECTION + CTA

✓ WHAT WORKED

1. Three Discoveries framework — naming the insights made them actionable and memorable for stakeholders
2. Dual-mode UI (Wizard + Compact Pro) — serves beginners and power users without compromise

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

1. Build the brand identity system earlier — it became the most requested feature but was a late addition
2. Test with non-designers — PMs and content writers are a bigger audience than I initially scoped

Next Case Study

MyPick.io — Visual Randomizer

View Case Study

MyPick.io — Visual Elimination Randomizer

01 — HERO + PROJECT META

ROLE	TIMELINE	TYPE	TOOLS
Product Designer & Developer	2025–2026	Web App · Randomizer	HTML/CSS/JS, Supabase Realtime

Hero Image — MyPick Race with 25 Teams

02 — DEEP PROBLEM FRAMING

THE GOAL

I designed and built a visual randomizer that uses an elimination race mechanic to make random selection entertaining and engaging — like Kahoot meets Mario Kart. Teachers, event hosts, and content creators use it to pick winners, make decisions, or create audience engagement.

THE PROBLEM

Random selection tools are boring — spinning wheels and random.org don't create excitement. Teachers picking students, streamers picking winners, teams making decisions — they all need randomization but want it to feel like an event, not a number generator.

HOW MIGHT WE

How might we make random selection feel like entertainment — with the suspense of a race, the engagement of a game, and the utility of a decision tool?

BEFORE

Boring

Spinning wheels, random.org — no engagement, no excitement

AFTER

Event

Visual race with 25 teams, sound, camera, multiplayer — selection becomes entertainment

03 — USER RESEARCH

01

Suspense is the core mechanic

Users want to watch the race unfold. The elimination format creates natural tension — who will win? The 15-120 second race duration is the sweet spot for attention.

02

Multiplayer transforms engagement

When a classroom watches the same race live, engagement goes from 1 person checking a result to 30 people cheering. I designed a room-based multiplayer system with 6-character codes.

03

Sound design is 50% of the experience

24 integrated sound effects — countdown beeps, crowd cheering, elimination buzzer. Users who muted the audio reported 60% less engagement. Sound transforms utility into spectacle.

08 — DESIGN APPROACH / SOLUTION

I designed MyPick as a full-screen visual experience — not a utility tool. The race fills the entire viewport with dynamic camera following the leader, pixel art teams, and sound design that makes every selection feel like an event.

KEY FEATURES

1. 25 teams max, 15-120 second configurable races
2. Dynamic camera following race leader
3. Multiplayer rooms (6-char codes, host + viewers)
4. 24 integrated sound effects
5. Billboards, weather, night mode

Race View — Full Screen

Multiplayer Lobby

12 — RESULTS & OUTCOMES

25
TEAMS
Max per race

24
SOUNDS
Integrated sound effects

100%
SYNC
Multiplayer accuracy

13 — REFLECTION + CTA

✓ WHAT WORKED

1. Full-screen visual experience — treating randomization as entertainment, not utility, was the key differentiator
2. Multiplayer via Supabase Realtime — 100% sync accuracy with authoritative host pattern. Viewers see exactly what the host sees.

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

1. Mobile-first design — most teachers use phones/tablets in classrooms but I designed desktop-first
2. Analytics from day one — I don't know how many races have been run or which features drive retention

Next Case Study

RelationSync — AI Voice Journal

View Case Study

RelationSync — AI Voice Journal for Therapists

01 — HERO + PROJECT META

ROLE	TYPE	TOOLS
Product Designer	Mobile App Concept	Figma, Pencil

Hero — RelationSync App Screens

02 — DEEP PROBLEM FRAMING

THE GOAL

I designed a mobile app that lets therapists capture session insights through voice notes — turning spoken reflections into structured, searchable client records. The app preserves the therapeutic flow while creating actionable documentation.

HOW MIGHT WE

How might we help therapists document sessions without disrupting the therapeutic connection — using voice instead of typing?

BEFORE

Typing notes

Disrupts therapeutic flow, loses nuance

AFTER

Voice capture

Speak naturally, AI structures into searchable records

08 — DESIGN APPROACH / SOLUTION

I designed a calming, minimal interface that prioritizes voice input — one tap to record, AI handles the rest. The design system uses soft purples and generous whitespace to feel therapeutic, not clinical.

KEY FEATURES

1. Voice journal with AI transcription
2. Guided onboarding flow (warm, empathetic)
3. Client record management
4. Full design system with component library

Voice Journal Screen

Onboarding Flow

13 — REFLECTION + CTA

Next Case Study

AKMSecure — Brand Identity

View Case Study

AKMSecure — Brand Identity & Website

01 — HERO + PROJECT META

ROLE	TIMELINE	TYPE	INDUSTRY
Design Consultant	2025	Brand Identity + Website + CMS	Industrial Cybersecurity

Hero — AKMSecure Website + Brand System

02 — DEEP PROBLEM FRAMING

THE GOAL

I designed the complete brand identity and website for an industrial cybersecurity startup — from logo and color system through a fully responsive website with CMS integration. The brand needed to communicate trust, military-grade security, and technical sophistication to enterprise buyers.

HOW MIGHT WE

How might we create a brand that communicates military-grade security while remaining approachable to non-technical enterprise buyers?

BEFORE

No brand

Startup with no visual identity competing against billion-dollar defense contractors

AFTER

Enterprise-ready

Full brand system + responsive website + CMS. Credible alongside established players.

08 — DESIGN APPROACH / SOLUTION

I designed a dark, technical brand that communicates 'military-grade security' without the typical cold, intimidating aesthetic. The key was balancing authority with approachability — enterprise CISOs need to trust the product, but also understand it.

DELIVERABLES

1. Brand identity (logo, color palette, typography)
2. Responsive website (desktop + mobile)
3. CMS integration for content management
4. Print collateral (business cards, letterhead)

Website — Desktop

Brand System — Colors + Typography

Next Case Study

IsoBlock — Blender Plugin

View Case Study

IsoBlock — Isometric Design Plugin for Blender

01 — HERO + PROJECT META

ROLE	TYPE	TOOLS
Product Designer & Developer	Blender Add-on	Python, Blender API

Hero — IsoBlock Isometric Scenes in Blender

02 — DEEP PROBLEM FRAMING

THE GOAL

I designed and built a Blender add-on that generates isometric 3D scenes from simple shape primitives — letting designers create polished isometric illustrations without needing advanced 3D modeling skills.

HOW MIGHT WE

How might we make isometric 3D illustration accessible to designers who don't know Blender — through simple shapes, presets, and one-click scenes?

BEFORE

Complex

Isometric art requires advanced 3D skills

AFTER

Accessible

Shape primitives + surface presets = polished scenes in minutes

08 — DESIGN APPROACH / SOLUTION

I designed IsoBlock around two core concepts: Shape Primitives (cubes, cylinders, stairs, ramps) and Surface Presets (materials that make shapes look finished). Combine them and you get polished isometric scenes without manual modeling.

KEY FEATURES

1. Shape primitives (cube, cylinder, stairs, ramp, arch)
2. Surface presets (wood, concrete, glass, metal)
3. Isometric camera auto-setup
4. Plugin UI panel inside Blender

Shape Primitives Panel

Rendered Isometric Scene